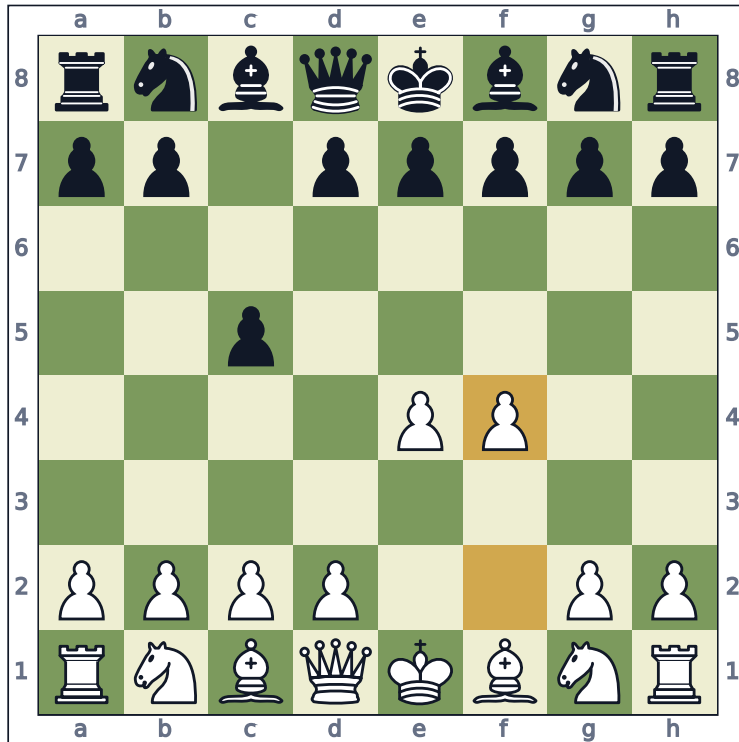


SICILIAN DEFENSE

Sicilian Defense

ECO B21 | 37 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

-0.10 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Active and tactical: both sides must calculate forcing moves before following a thematic plan.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B21 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: McDonnell Attack.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. f4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

BLACK'S GOALS

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. The word 'attack' is a name, not a guarantee; complete development before forcing matters.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on e4, White pawn on f4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B21 line

This section preserves all 37 names and defining routes assigned to B21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Bird Opening: Dutch Variation, Batavo Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. f4 d5 3. Nf3 dxe4

002 Sicilian Defense: Coles Sicilian Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. Qxd4 Nc6 4. Qd1 Nf6 5. Bc4

003 Sicilian Defense: Halasz Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. f4

004 Sicilian Defense: McDonnell Attack

1. e4 c5 2. f4

005 Sicilian Defense: McDonnell Attack, Tal Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. f4 d5 3. exd5 Nf6

006 Sicilian Defense: McDonnell Attack, Toilet Variation

1. e4 c5 2. f4 d5 3. Nc3

007 Sicilian Defense: Morphy Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. Nf3

008 Sicilian Defense: Morphy Gambit, Andreaschek Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. Nf3 e5 4. c3

009 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. d4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B21 line

This section preserves all 37 names and defining routes assigned to B21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3

011 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3

012 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Chicago Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 d6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Nf6 7. O-O a6

013 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Chicago Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Bc4 e6 6. Nf3 d6 7. O-O a6 8. Qe2 b5 9. Bb3 Ra7

014 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Classical Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 d6 6. Bc4 a6 7. O-O Nf6

015 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Danish Variation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nf3

016 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Fianchetto Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 g6

017 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Fianchetto Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 g6

018 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Fianchetto Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 d6 5. Nf3 g6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B21 line

This section preserves all 37 names and defining routes assigned to B21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Fianchetto Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 d6 6. Bc4 g6

020 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Finegold Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 e6 5. Nf3 d6 6. Bc4 a6 7. O-O Be7 8. Qe2 Nf6

021 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Kan Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 e6 5. Nf3 a6

022 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Larsen Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Qc7 7. Qe2 a6 8. O-O Bd6

023 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Morphy Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Bc5

024 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Morphy Defense Deferred

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 a6 7. O-O b5 8. Bb3 Bc5

025 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Paulsen Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 a6

026 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Pin Defense

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Bb4

027 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Scheveningen Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 d6 6. Bc4 e6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B21 line

This section preserves all 37 names and defining routes assigned to B21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

028 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Siberian Variation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Qc7

029 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Siberian Variation, Siberian Trap

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Bc4 Qc7 7. Qe2 Nf6 8. O-O Ng4

030 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Sozin Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Bc4 e6 6. Nf3 d6 7. O-O a6 8. Qe2 b5

031 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted, Taimanov Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 e6 5. Bc4 a6 6. Nf3 Ne7

032 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Declined, Alapin Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 Nf6

033 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Declined, Center Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 e5

034 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Declined, Dubois Variation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 d3 4. c4

035 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Declined, Push Variation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 d3

036 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Declined, Scandinavian Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 d5

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B21 line

This section preserves all 37 names and defining routes assigned to B21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

037

Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Declined, Wing Formation

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 Qa5